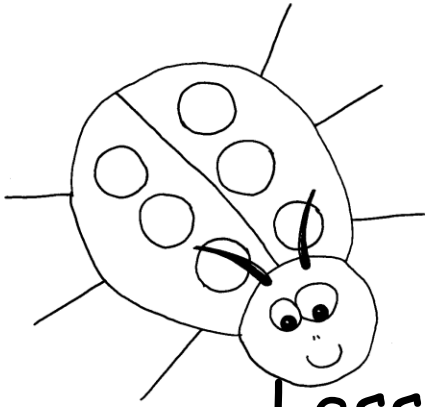
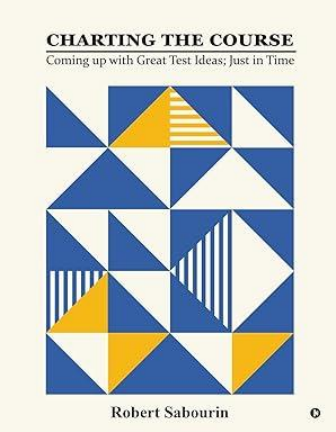
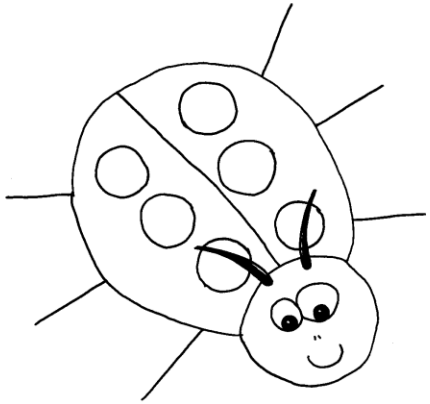


Lessons from Hollywood Action Heroes: Exploring, Adapting, Improvising

Robert Sabourin
President & Principal consultant
AmiBug.Com, Inc.
Montreal, Canada
robsab@gmail.com

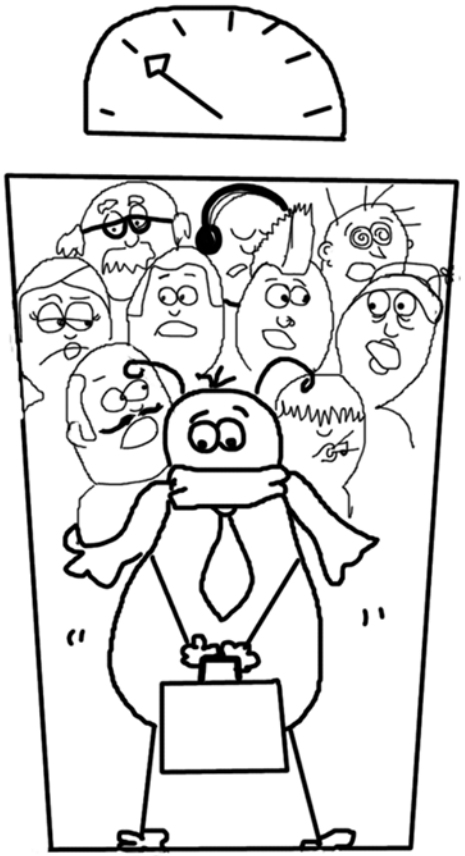


© Robert Sabourin, 2026



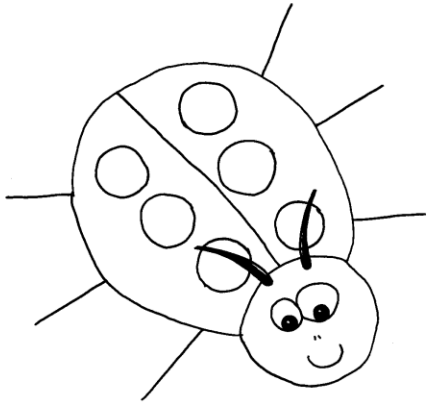
"Action Heroes"

- Overview
  - Learning, Metaphors
  - Sherlock Holmes
  - Mission Impossible
  - Indiana Jones
  - Die Hard
  - Bond
  - Some other lessons



© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.

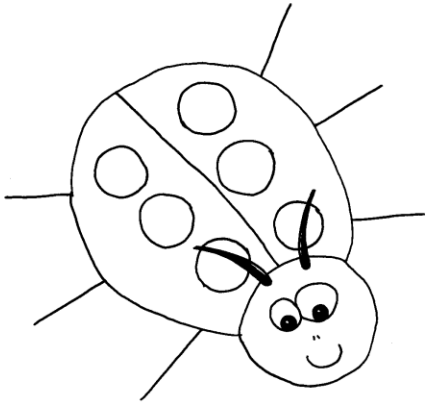


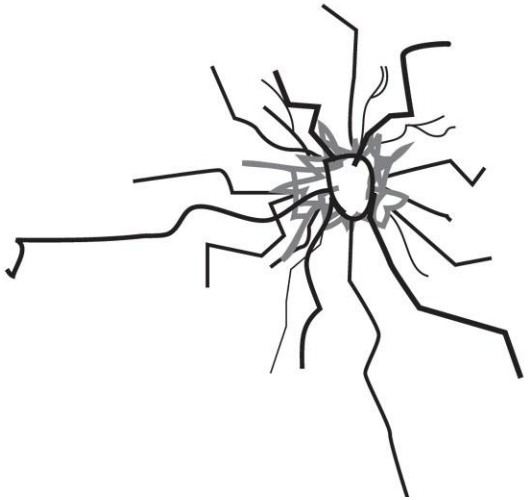
Learning and Metaphors

- Teaching
- Learning
- Retaining
- Applying knowledge
- Share experiences
- Don’t get carried away …

© Robert Sabourin, 2026

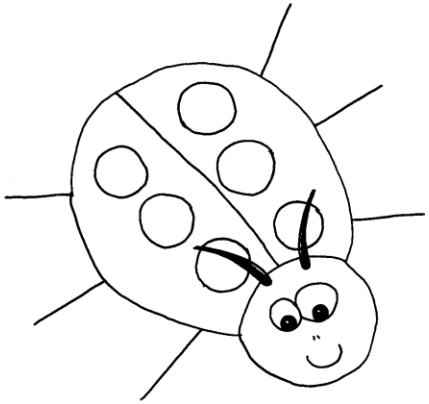
AmiBug.Com, Inc.





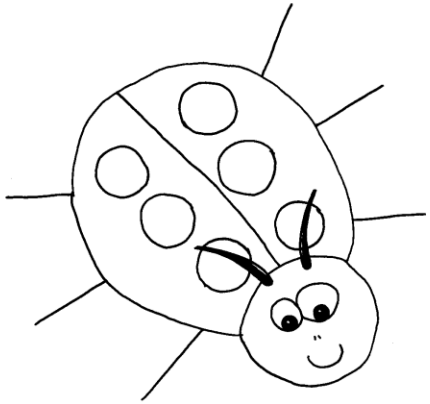
© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.

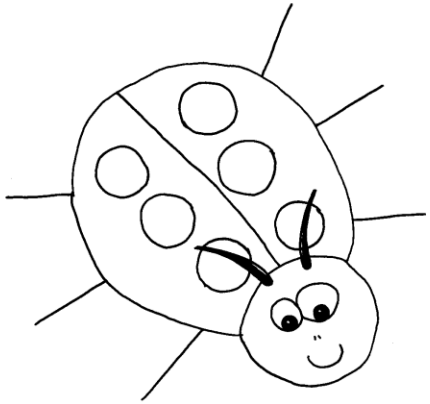


Sherlock Holmes

- A. Canon Doyle
- “The great detective”
- Partner Dr. Watson
- Nemesis Dr. Moriarity
- Stories, novels
- Theater, Movie, Radio

© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.

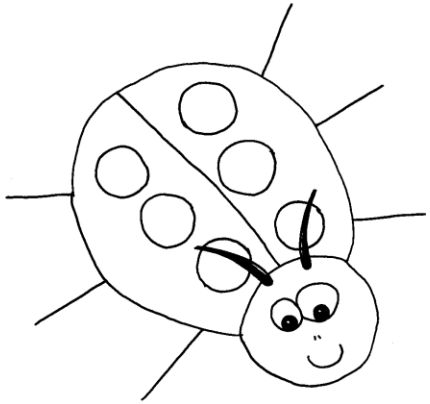


Sherlock Holmes

- Deductive reasoning
- Analysis and action
- “Elementary”
- Reconstruct event chains
- “See and observe”
- Footprints, ashes, creosote

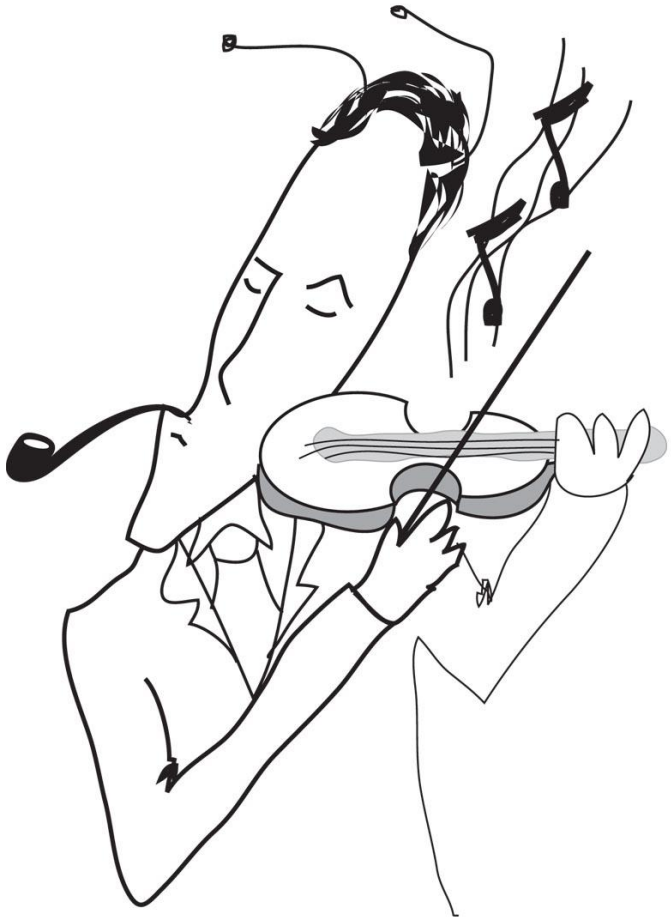
© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



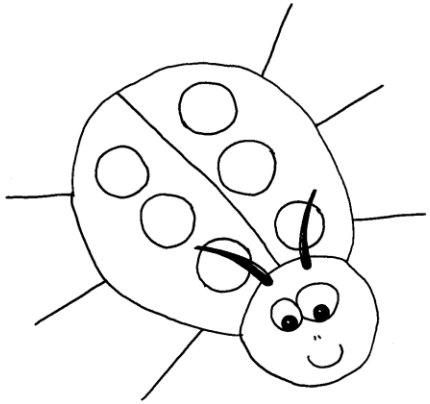
Sherlock Holmes

1. Exploratory testing
2. Observe, assess, act
3. Attention all details
4. Traps to isolate bugs
5. Improbable not impossible
6. *Work with a partner who takes great notes*



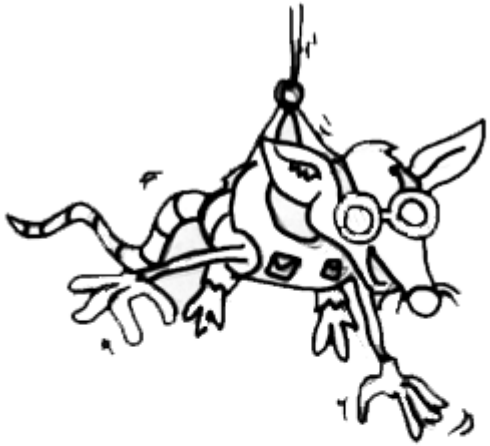
© Robert Sabourin, 2026

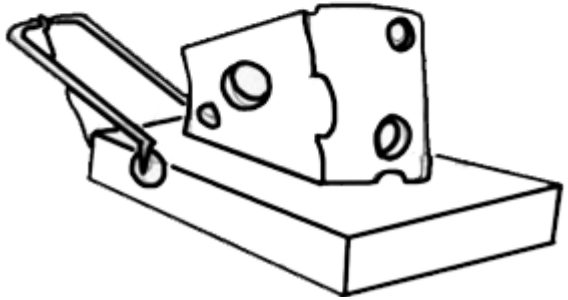
AmiBug.Com, Inc.



Mission Impossible

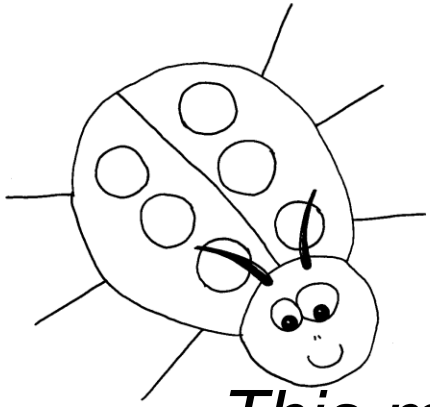
- Tom Cruise play Ethan Hunt
- “IMF”
- Impossible Mission Force
- Classic 1960s TV
- Action Movies





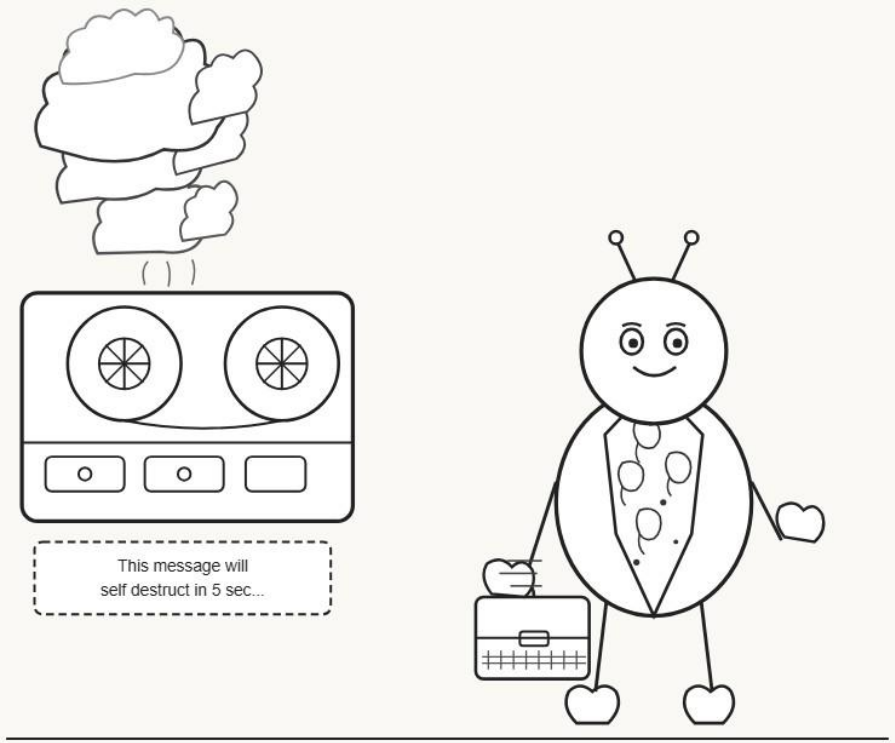
© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



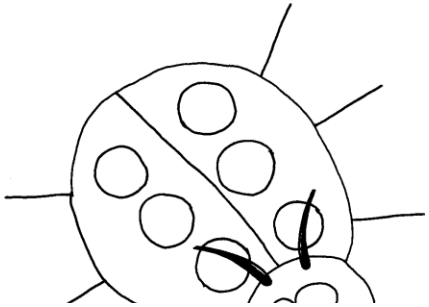
Mission Impossible

- *This message will self destruct in five seconds*
- Mission driven
  - Purposeful
  - Chartered
- Accountable
  - Responsible
  - Disavowed

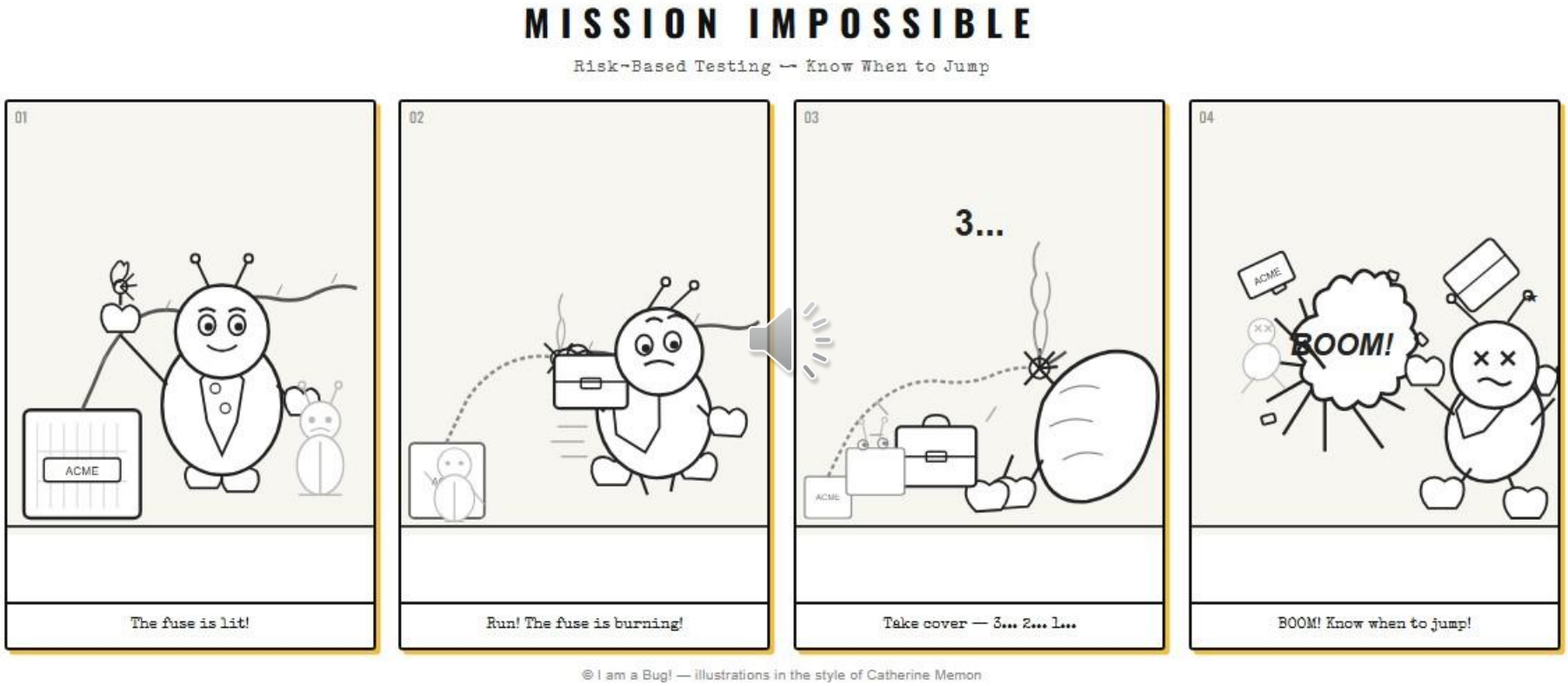


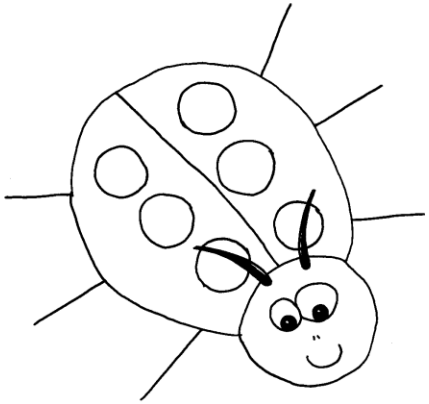
© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



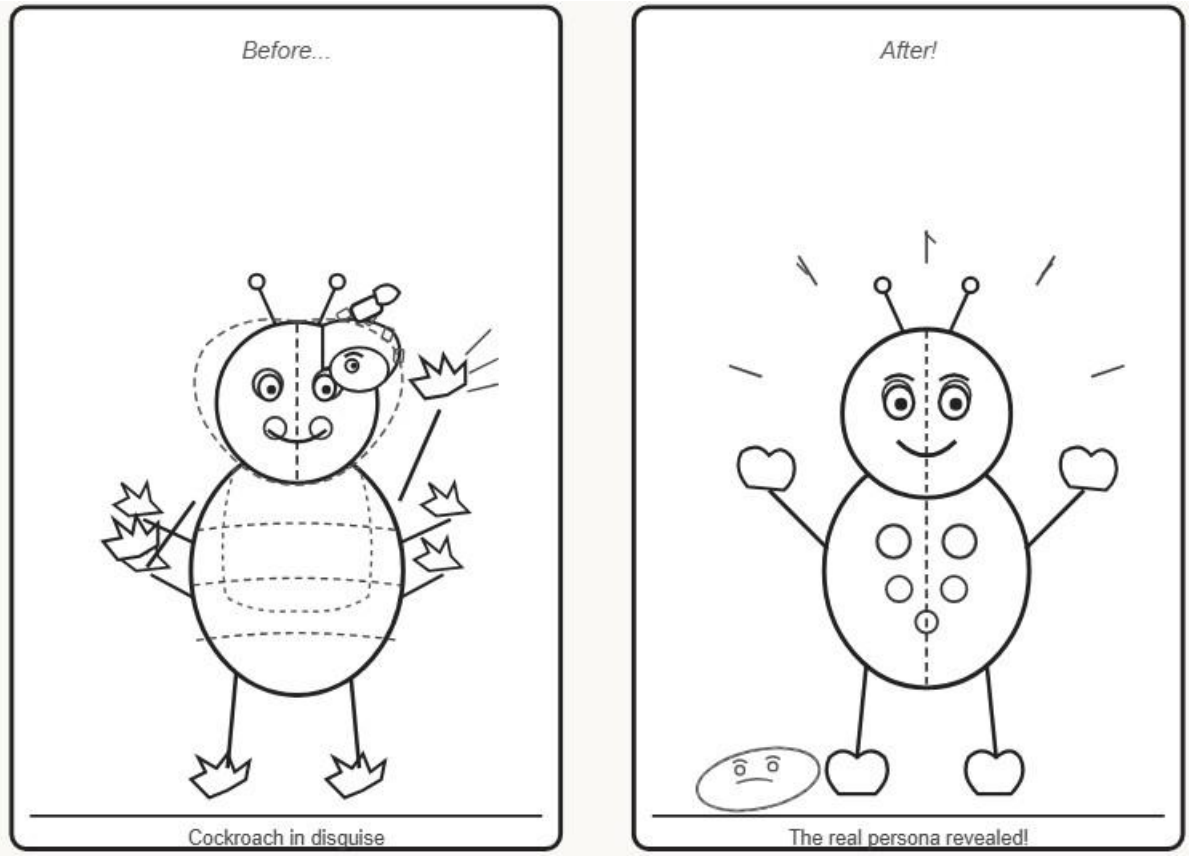
Mission Impossible





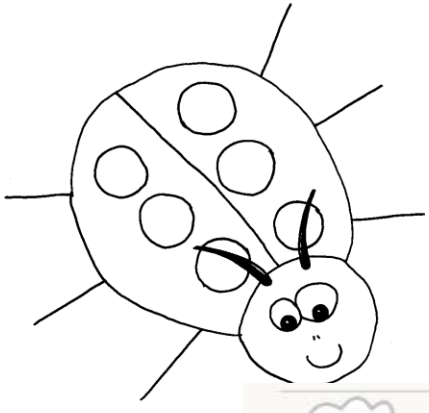
Mission Impossible

- *Personas*
- Masks
- Scenarios
- Context Switching

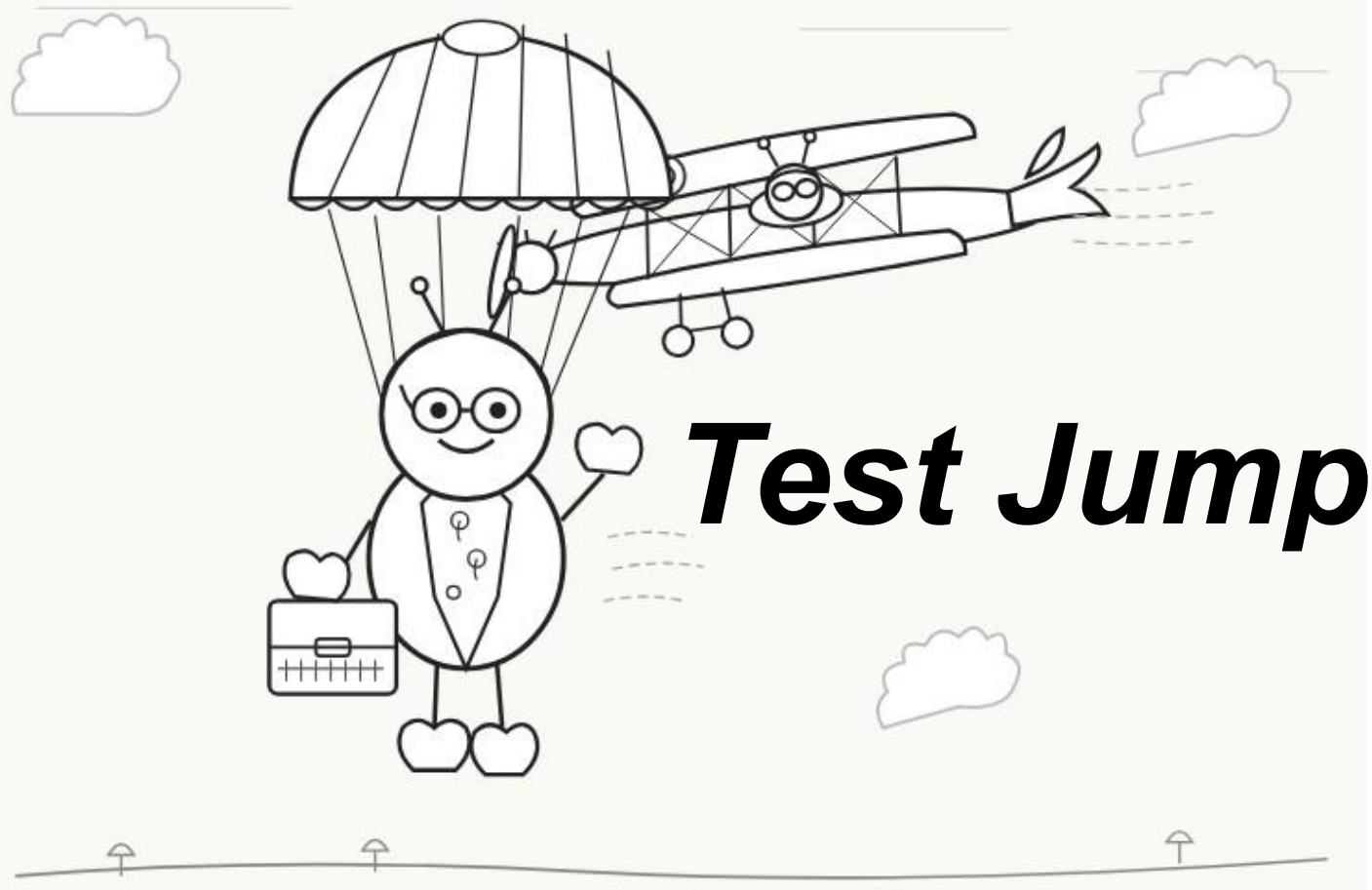


© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



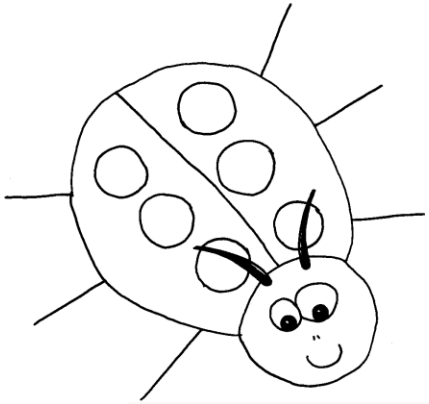
Mission Impossible



Test Jumping

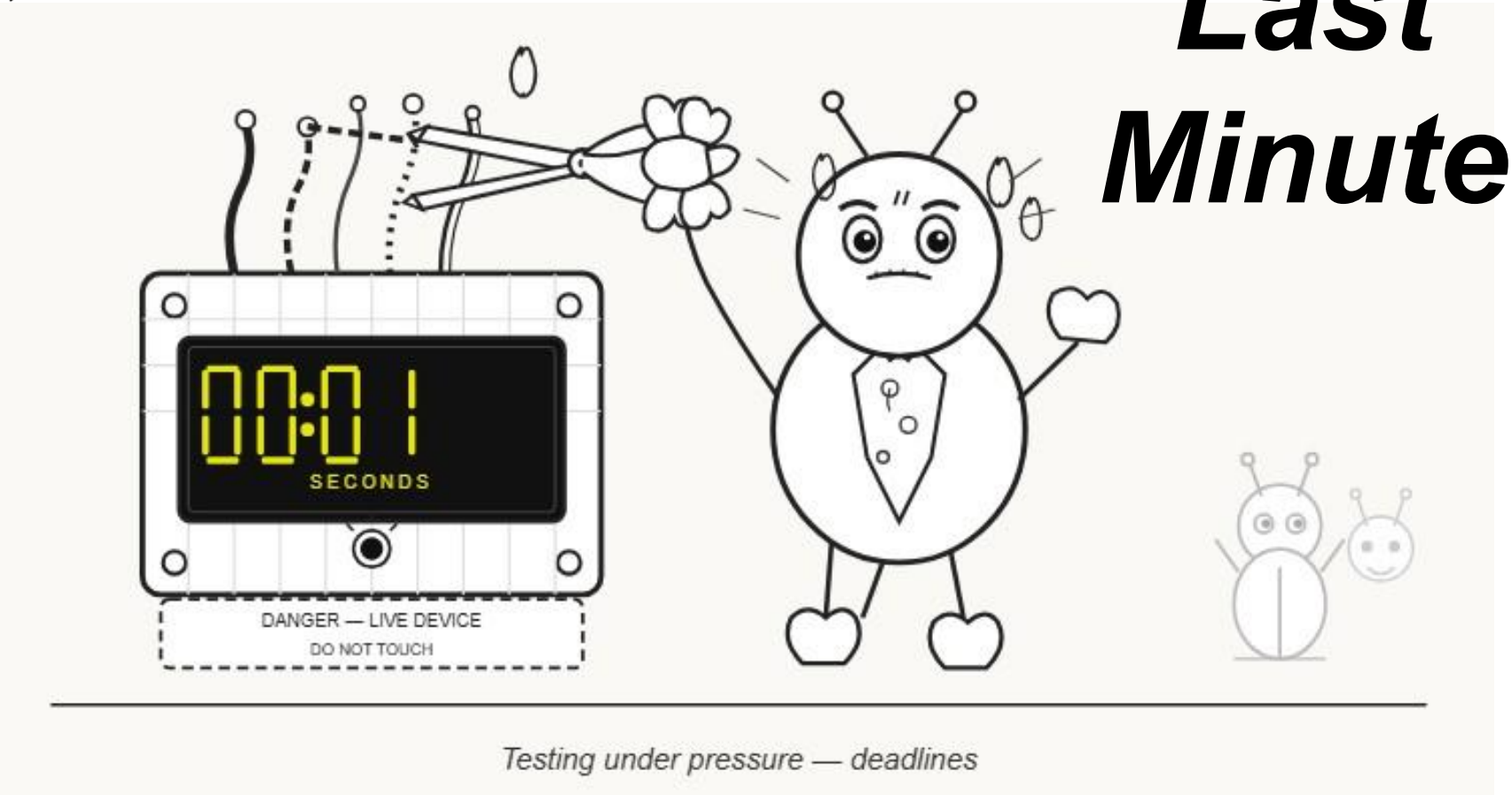
© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



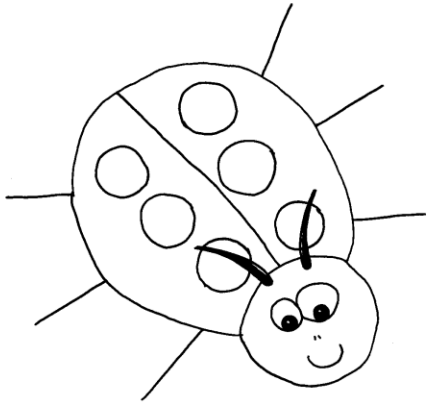
Mission Impossible

Last Minute



© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.

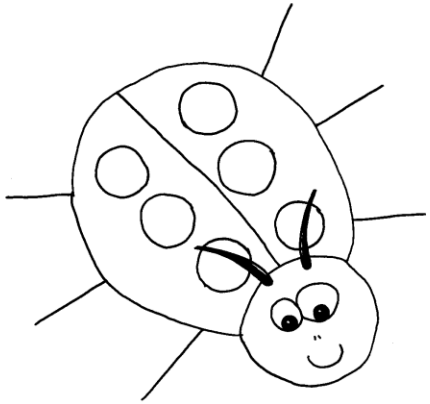


Indiana Jones

- Dr. Henry Walton
- "Indiana" Jones, Jr.
- Harrison Ford
- George Lucas

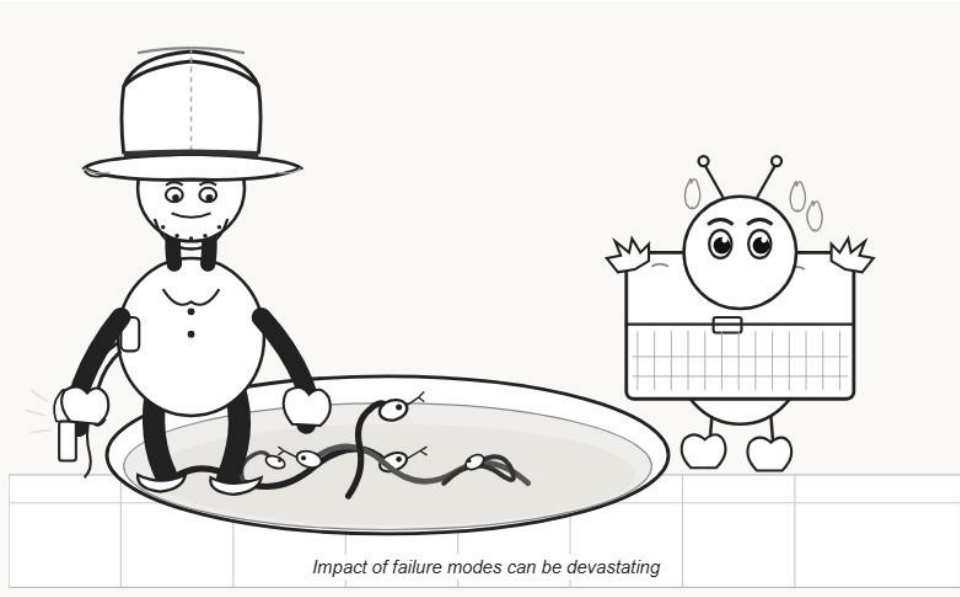
© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



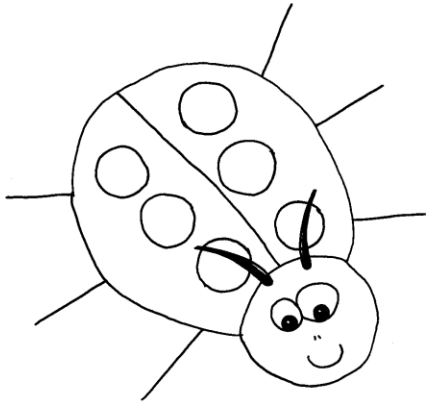
Indiana Jones

- Hate Snakes
- Recurrent risk
- Patterns
- Fear
- Annoyances

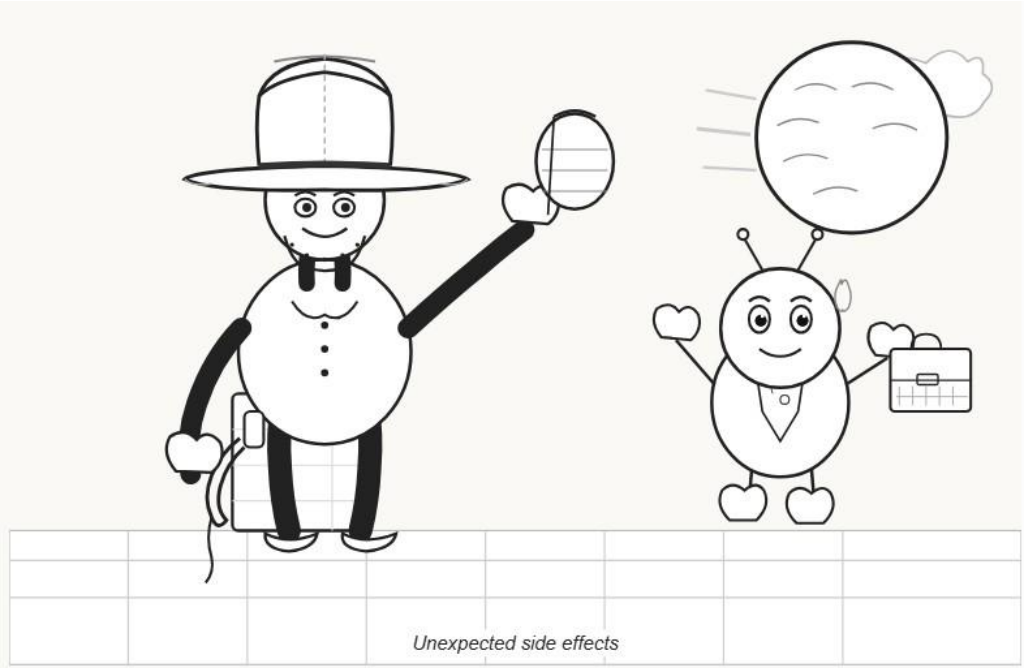


© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



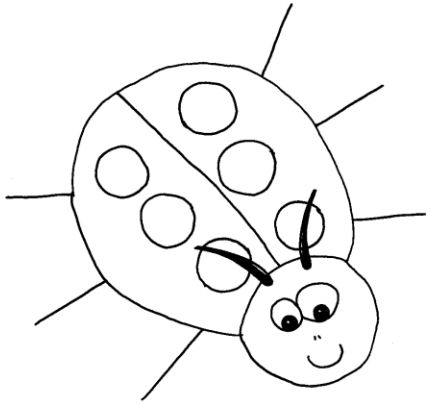
Indiana Jones



- Rolling boulder
- Unexpected
- Side effects
- Consequences
- Emergent behavior
- Get out of the way!

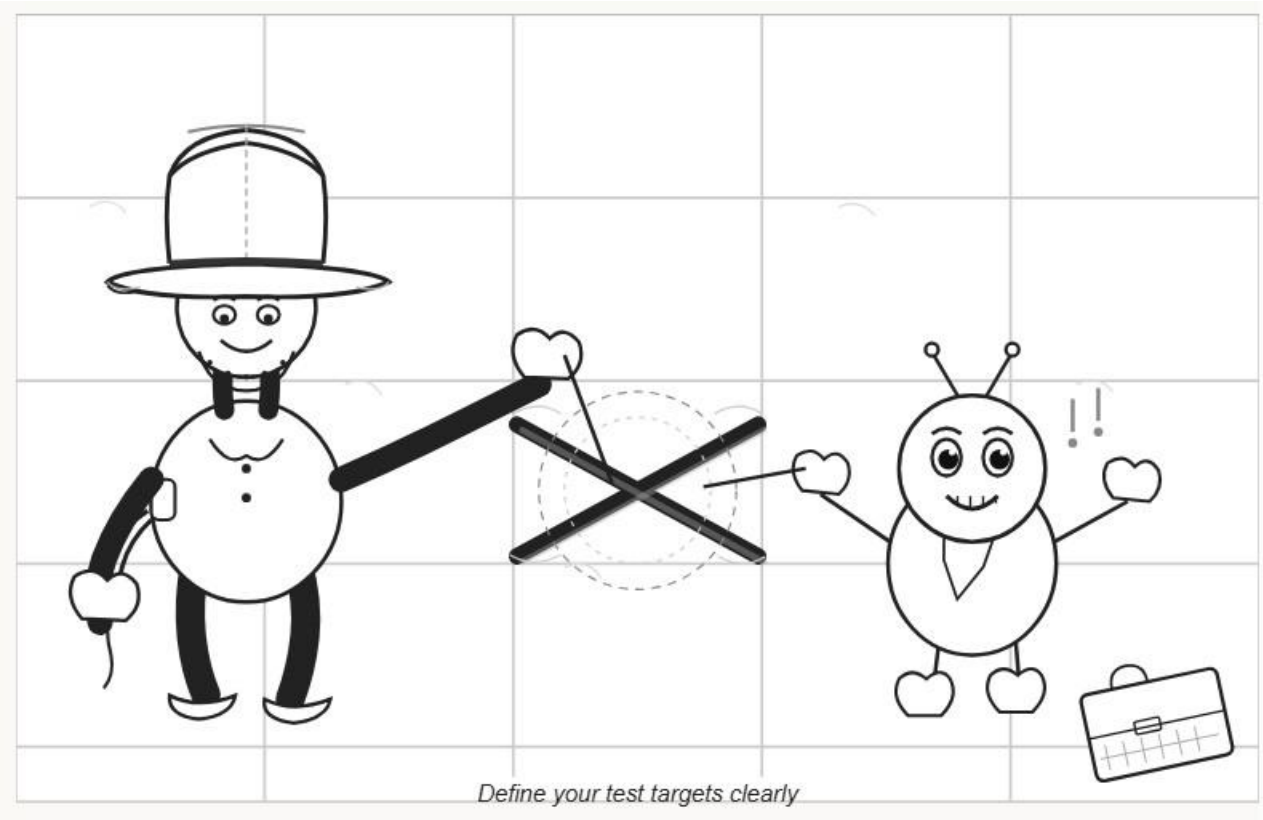
© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



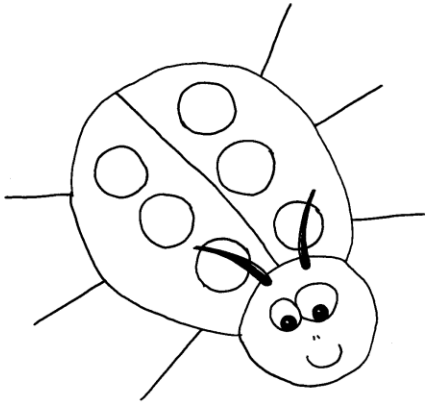
Indiana Jones

X never never marks the spot



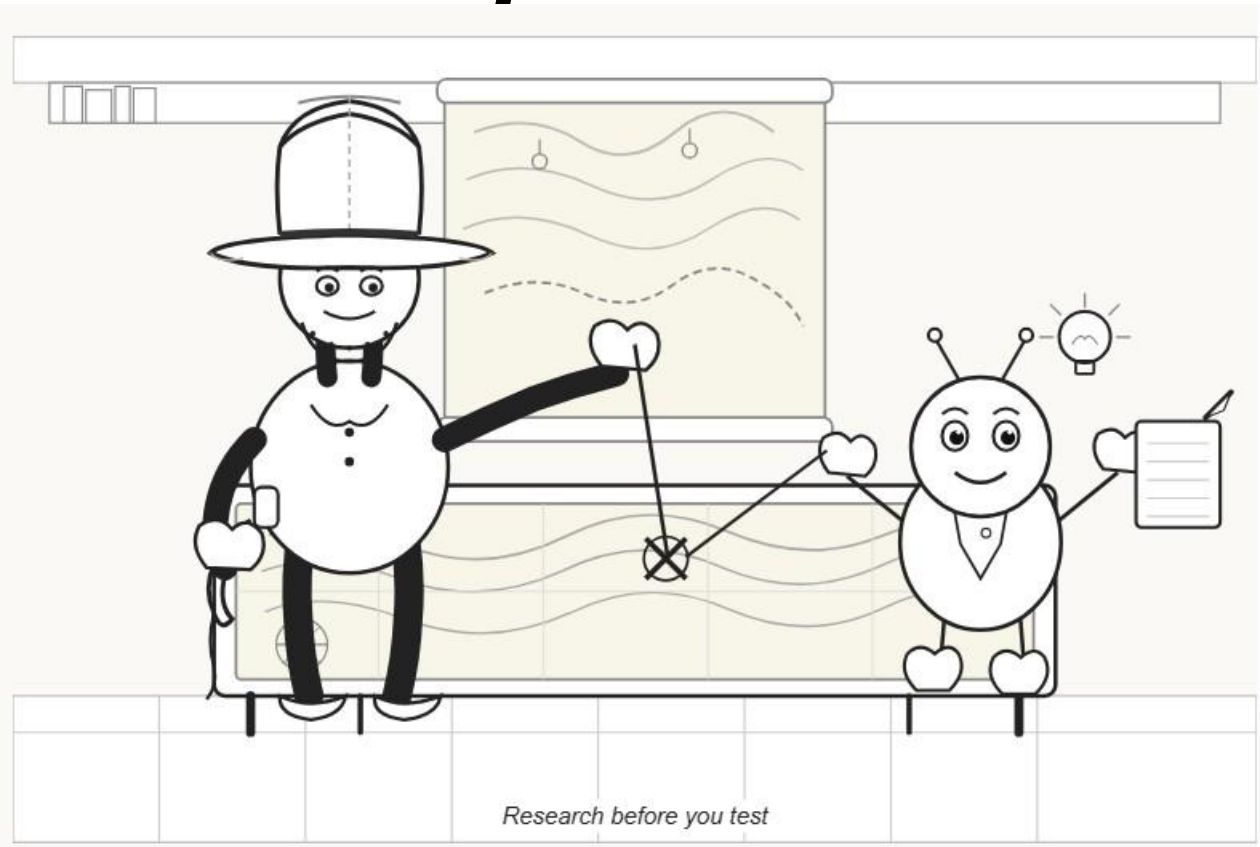
© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



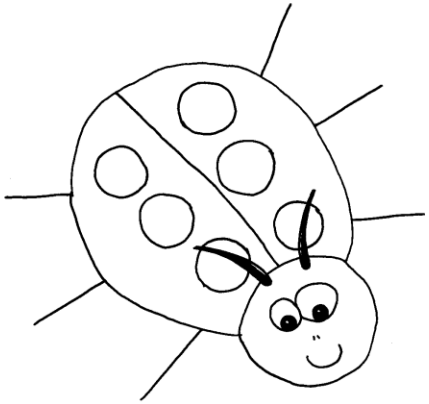
Indiana Jones

Map Room



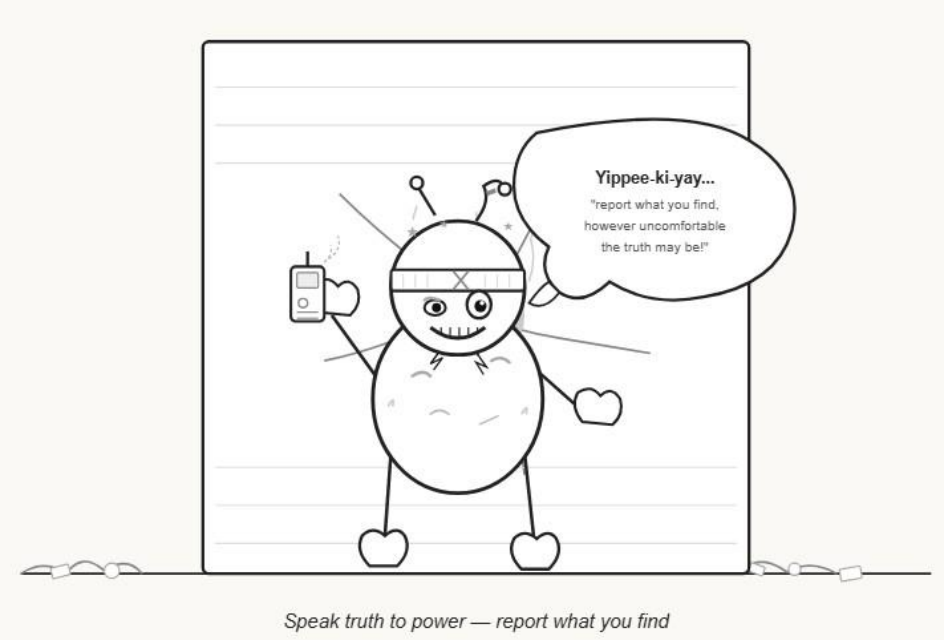
© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



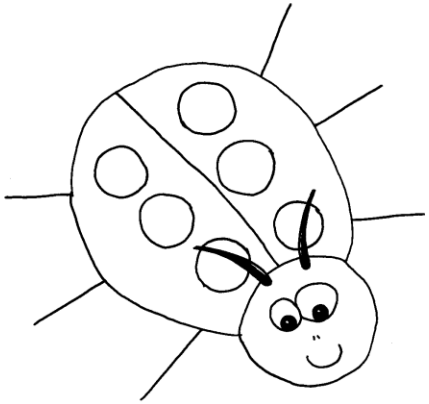
Die Hard

- John McClane Sr.
- Bruce Willis
- Situational irony
- Fish out of water
- Nothing but action

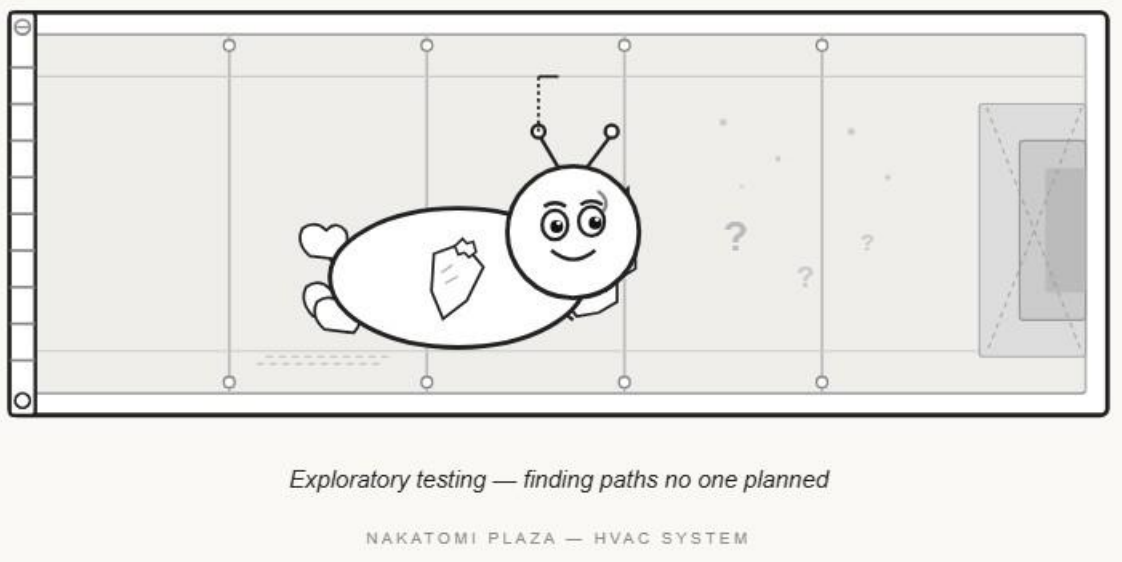


© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



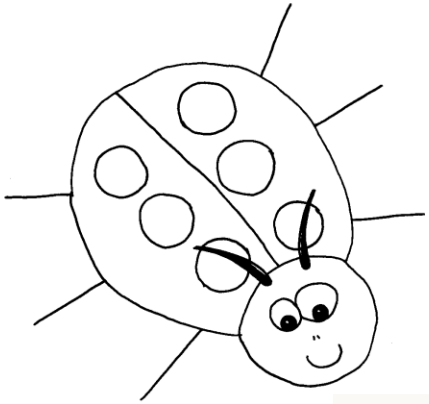
Die Hard



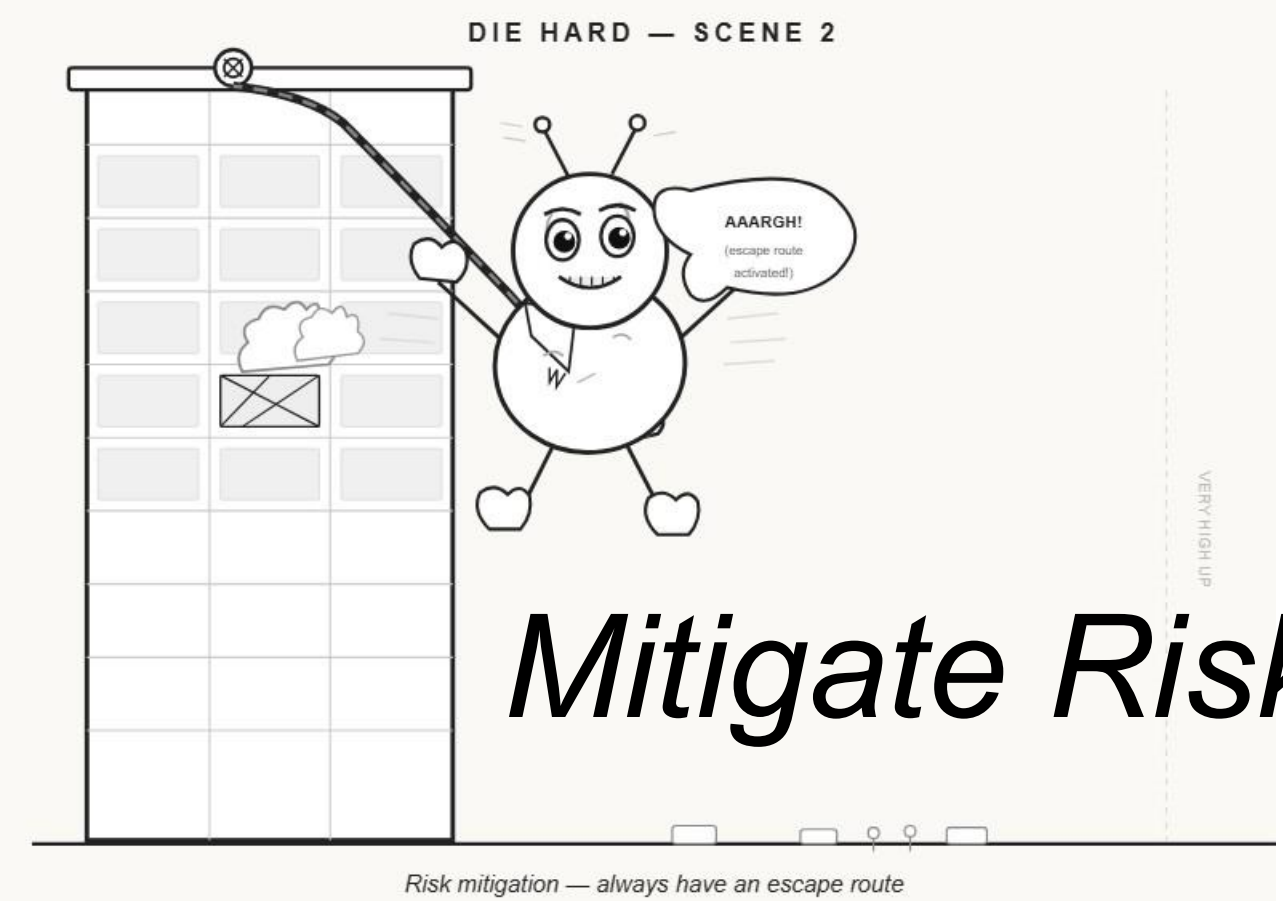
Sneaking around unlikely places

© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.

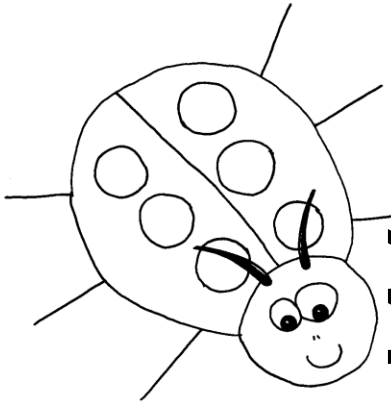


Die Hard



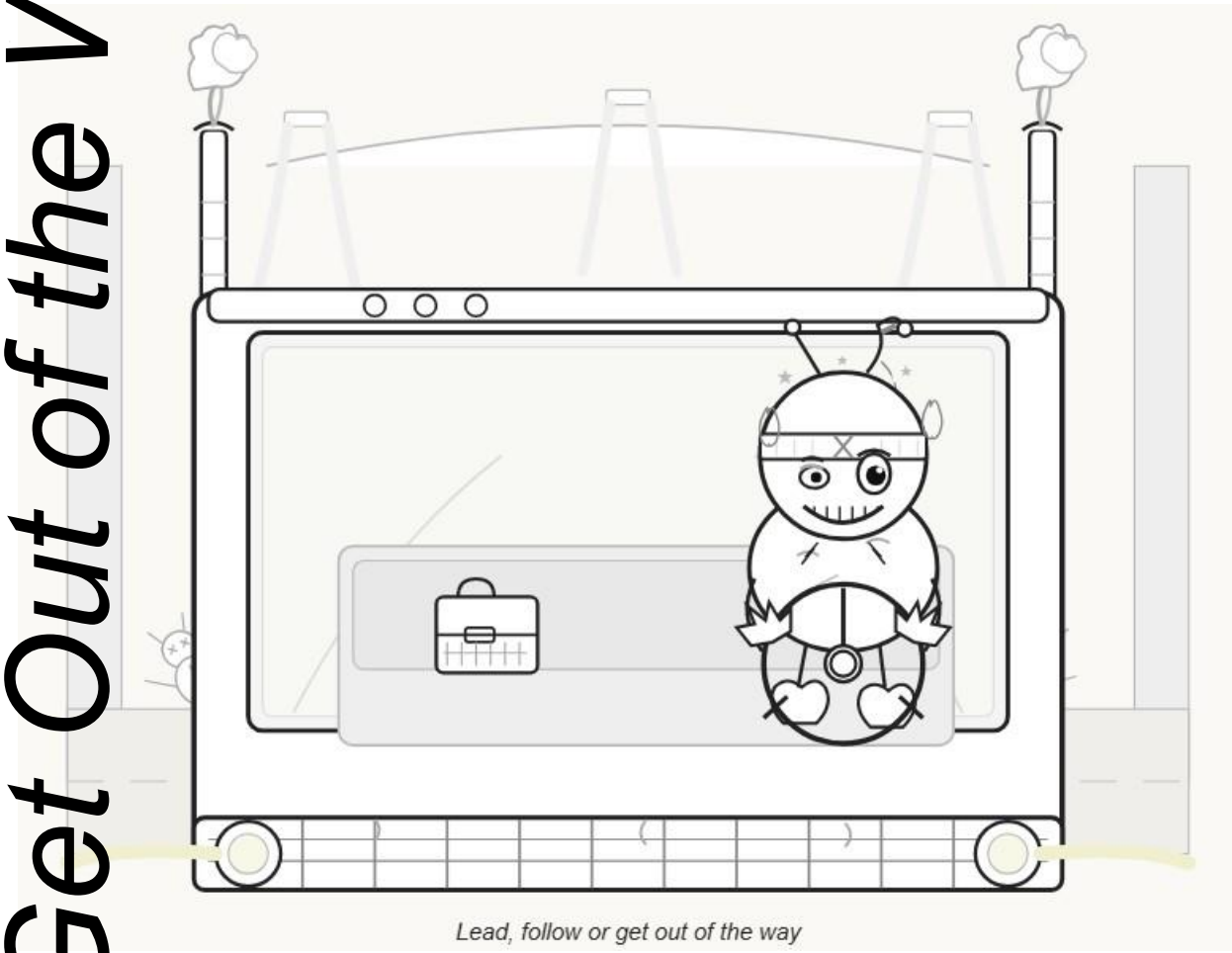
Mitigate Risks

© Robert Sabourin, 2026



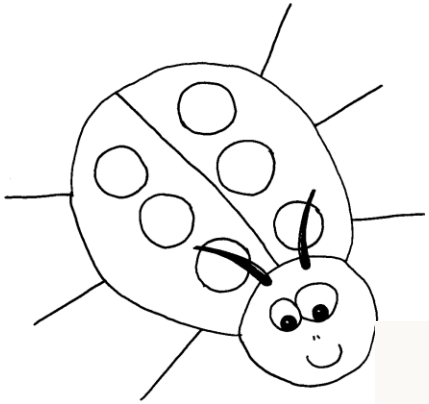
Lead
Follow or
Get Out of the Way

Die Hard

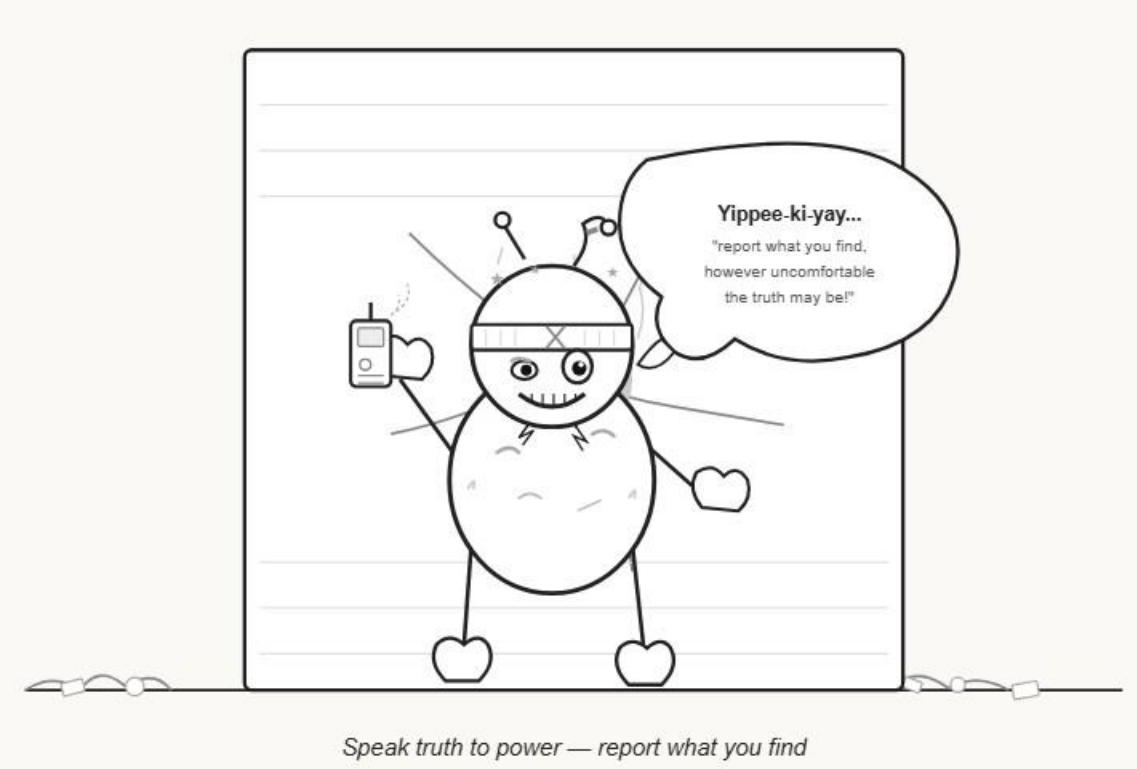


© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



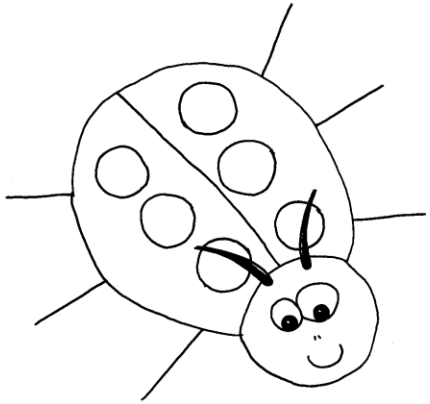
Die Hard



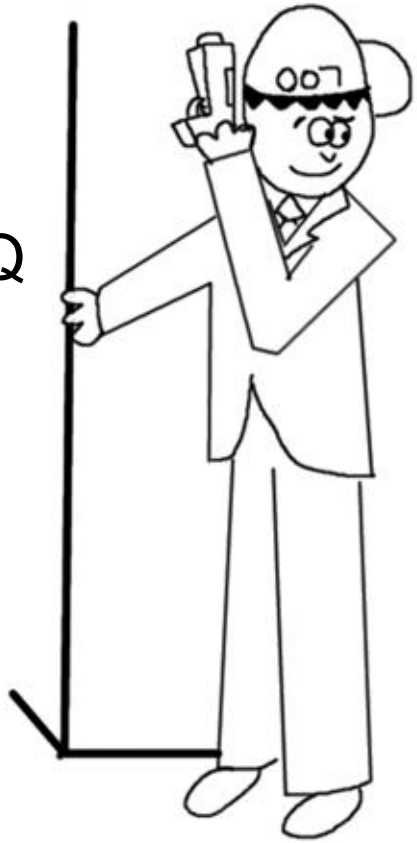
Truth will set you free

© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.



"Bond - James Bond"

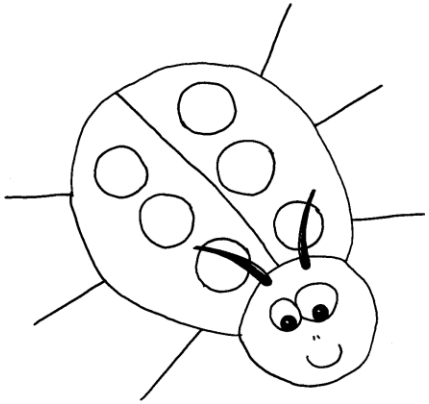


What I learned from James Bond

- There is a magic project somewhere
- Testers get the tools they need from Q
- Tools cost a lot and really work
- Magic bug finding lasers
- Parachute ejector seats to avoid PMs
- Testers find bugs
- Testers solve all the problems
- Testers save the world
- Testers get the girl
- With a license to kill so developers answer your questions
- And actually read your bug reports!

© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.

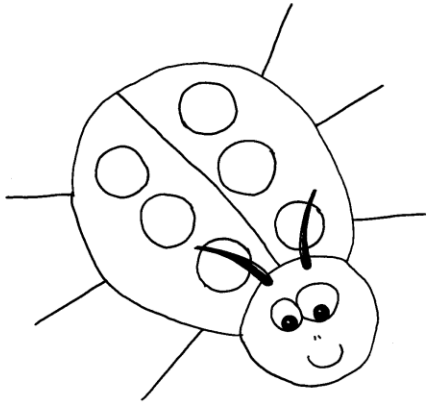


"Metaphors are limited"

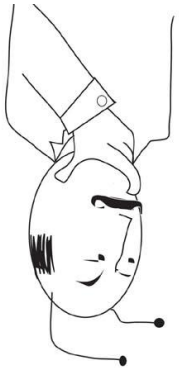
Testers	Action Heros
See a project all the way through	Stop after apprehending the crook
Watch developers take the credit	Are always seen as the hero
Trudging along all sorts of projects	Always assigned to cool projects

© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.

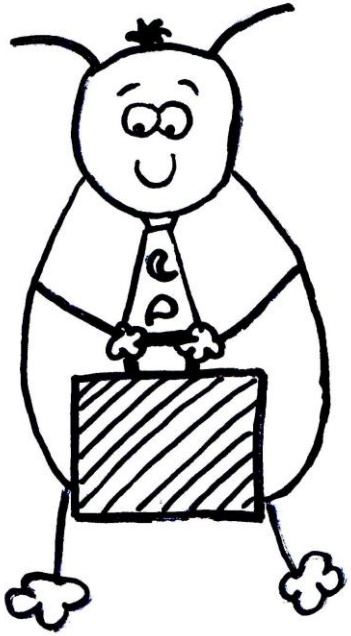


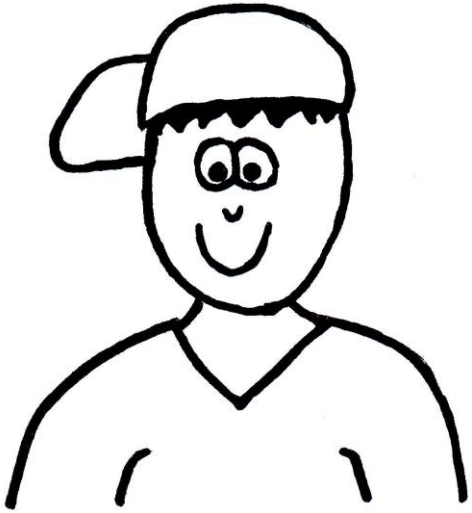
Thank You

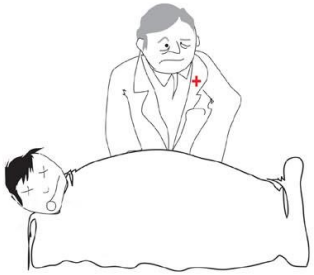


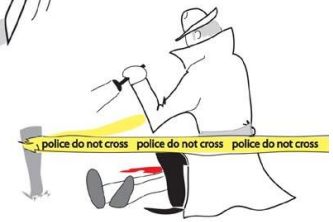
The Amibug Elite

Questions?









© Robert Sabourin, 2026

AmiBug.Com, Inc.